

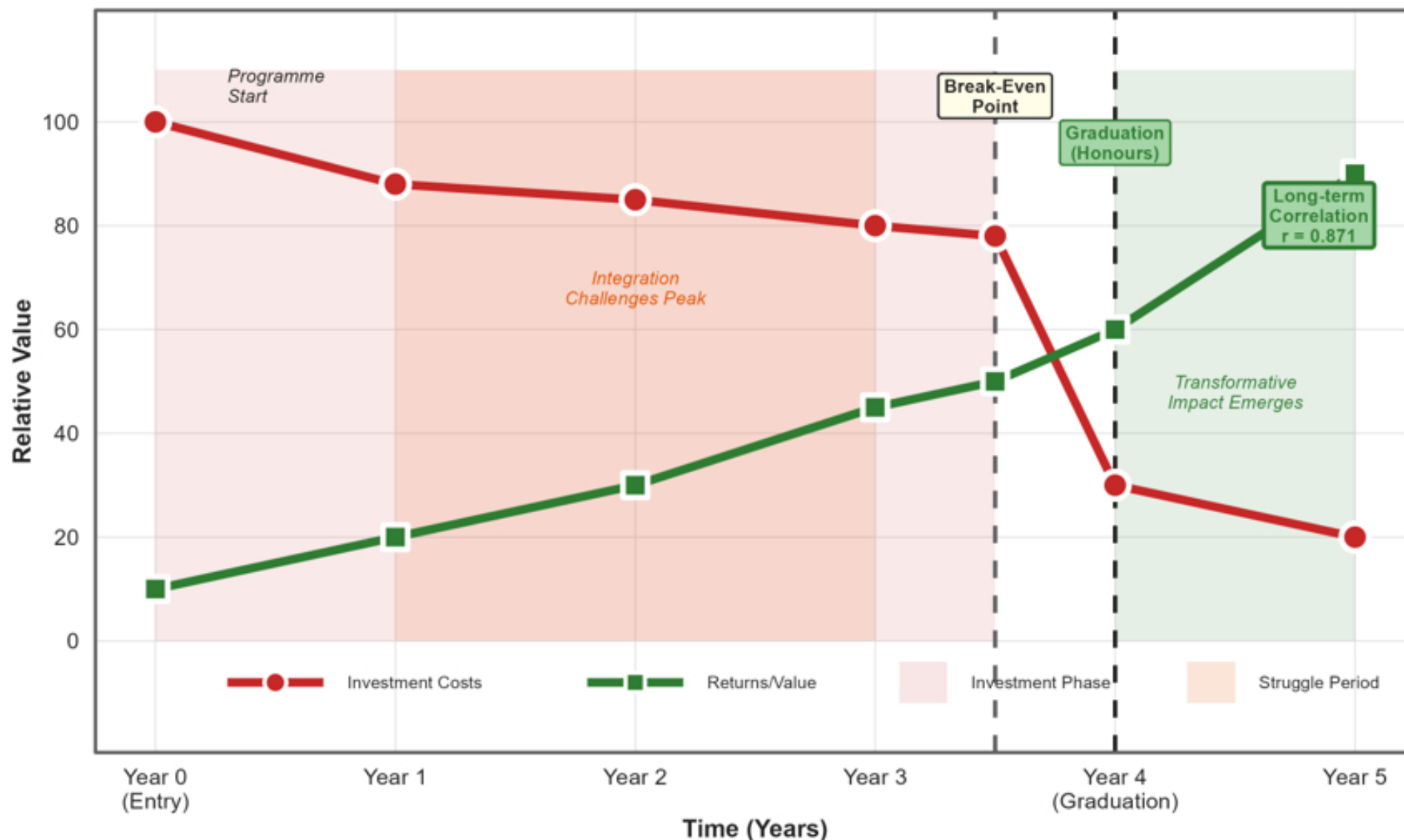


Figure 5. ROI evolution over 5-year horizon illustrating temporal tension in Graduate Apprenticeship investment. Based on Honours pathway (4-year programme). Employers face high upfront costs (red line) and integration struggle periods (amber shading), but significant returns emerge post-graduation (green line and shading). Short-term business metrics conflict with long-term developmental benefits. The exceptional long-term correlation ($r = .871$) validates sustained programme impact. Source: Author's analysis.